OCHORUS ORIGINALS · SERIES PLAN

A Cloud of Praying Witnesses

Two thousand years of mighty prayer, from the Psalms Jesus prayed to the global church today

11 volumes · 198 chapters

"Since we are surrounded by so great a cloud of witnesses…"
Hebrews 12:1

"…golden bowls full of incense, which are the prayers of the saints."
Revelation 5:8

Draft for the founder's review · 29 October 2026

Draft for the founder's approval. Nothing here is written prose yet; this is the map the volumes will be written from.

> *"Since we are surrounded by so great a cloud of witnesses..." (Hebrews 12:1)*
> *"...golden bowls full of incense, which are the prayers of the saints." (Revelation 5:8)*

Decisions (founder, 2026-10-28)

QUESTION	DECISION
Series name	**A Cloud of Praying Witnesses**
Shape	Series of 11 volumes, chronological, each standing on its own
Breadth	Whole Church: Orthodox, Catholic, Protestant, Pentecostal; gentle notes where traditions differ
Old Testament prelude	Yes
Byline	Ochorus (author `ochorus-originals`, as every house Original)
Bible	Open Word Bible (OWB), Balanced edition, with the house setting that capitalises pronouns for God (He, His), as *Faithful With Little*
Modern era	Named people are fine, living ones included

One technical note on numbering

Ochorus counts series volumes from **1** (a database rule; the cover draws the numeral). So the Old Testament prelude is **Volume 1**, and Jesus is Volume 2. The prelude stays a true prelude in feel: its title and introduction say so.

Shape of every volume

- **Introduction: "Where we are in the story"** (1 page): the era, the map, what to watch for.
- **15–20 chapters**, about 1,000–1,400 words each (a 6–9 minute read).
- **Conclusion: "Passing the torch"**: what this era hands to the next volume.
- **Appendix A: Key Insights**, grouped by theme, each pointing to chapter and person.
- **Appendix B: Scripture Index**, in Bible order, each verse pointing to chapters and people.

Both appendices are generated by script from each chapter's data record (person, era, region, anchor verse, other verses, insights tagged by theme), so they never drift from the text and rebuild in every language.

Shape of every chapter

1. **Anchor scripture**: one OWB verse, quoted in full

2. **The scene**: a story moment
3. **Who they were**: era, place, why it matters
4. **How they prayed**: their own words where we may quote them (verbatim from the Ochorus library where the book is there)
5. **Three key insights**
6. **For us today**
7. **Try this**: one prayer practice for the week
8. **A closing prayer**
9. **Questions for reflection** (2–3)
10. **Read more on Ochorus**: their books, sermons and author page

★ below = already has an Ochorus author page, so the chapter can link straight to their own words.

Where a famous story or saying is uncertain, the chapter says so ("the story is told…"). Known cases are flagged ⚑ below.

VOLUME 1

The Prayers Jesus Learned

Prayer in the Old Testament (a prelude) · 17 chapters

#	CHAPTER	PERSON	ANCHOR
1	The Friend Who Pleaded for a City	Abraham	Genesis 18:25
2	"I Will Not Let You Go"	Jacob	Genesis 32:26
3	Standing in the Gap	Moses	Exodus 32:11
4	"Show Me Your Glory"	Moses	Exodus 33:18
5	Pouring Out the Soul	Hannah	1 Samuel 1:15
6	The Sin of Not Praying	Samuel	1 Samuel 12:23
7	One Thing I Ask	David	Psalm 27:4
8	A Clean Heart	David	Psalm 51:10
9	If My People Will Pray	Solomon	2 Chronicles 7:14
10	Fire from Heaven, Rain on the Earth	Elijah	1 Kings 18:37
11	"Our Eyes Are on You"	Jehoshaphat	2 Chronicles 20:12
12	Spreading the Letter Before the Lord	Hezekiah	2 Kings 19:14–15
13	A Prayer from the Depths	Jonah	Jonah 2:2
14	Windows Open Toward Jerusalem	Daniel	Daniel 6:10
15	Arrow Prayers and Long Fasts	Nehemiah	Nehemiah 2:4
16	"How Long, O Lord?" Honest Prayer	The psalms of lament	Psalm 13:1
17	Though the Fig Tree Does Not Blossom	Habakkuk	Habakkuk 3:17–18

VOLUME 2

Lord, Teach Us to Pray

Jesus, the Teacher of Prayer · 20 chapters

#	CHAPTER	FOCUS	ANCHOR
1	Very Early in the Morning	Jesus' solitary prayer	Mark 1:35
2	All Night on the Mountain	Prayer before choosing the Twelve	Luke 6:12
3	"Lord, Teach Us to Pray"	The disciples' request	Luke 11:1
4	Our Father in Heaven	The Lord's Prayer (I)	Matthew 6:9–10
5	Bread, Forgiveness, Deliverance	The Lord's Prayer (II)	Matthew 6:11–13
6	The Secret Room	Praying unseen	Matthew 6:6
7	Ask, Seek, Knock	The friend at midnight	Luke 11:9
8	Always Pray and Never Give Up	The persistent widow	Luke 18:1
9	"God, Have Mercy on Me, a Sinner"	The tax collector	Luke 18:13
10	Faith That Moves Mountains	Believing prayer	Mark 11:24
11	Where Two or Three Agree	Praying together	Matthew 18:19–20
12	A House of Prayer for All Nations	Cleansing the temple	Mark 11:17
13	Ask the Lord of the Harvest	Praying for workers	Matthew 9:38
14	Thanks Before the Miracle	Lazarus' tomb	John 11:41–42
15	Asking in His Name	The promise of the Upper Room	John 16:24
16	"I Have Prayed for You"	Jesus prays for Peter	Luke 22:32
17	That They May All Be One	The prayer of John 17	John 17:21
18	Not My Will but Yours	Gethsemane; watch and pray	Matthew 26:39
19	Prayers from the Cross	"Father, forgive them"	Luke 23:34
20	He Always Lives to Pray for Us	Christ our intercessor now	Hebrews 7:25

VOLUME 3

Devoted to Prayer

The Apostles and the First Church · 20 chapters

#	CHAPTER	PERSON / MOVEMENT	ANCHOR
1	Waiting in the Upper Room	The 120	Acts 1:14
2	Devoted to the Prayers	The Jerusalem church	Acts 2:42
3	The Hour of Prayer	Peter and John at the gate	Acts 3:1
4	"Sovereign Lord": Praying Under Threat	The church after the arrest	Acts 4:31
5	We Will Give Ourselves to Prayer	The apostles' priority	Acts 6:4
6	"Do Not Hold This Sin Against Them"	Stephen	Acts 7:60
7	Prayers That Rose Before God	Cornelius	Acts 10:4
8	Peter in Prison, the Church on Its Knees	Mary's house	Acts 12:5
9	Worship, Fasting and Sending	Antioch	Acts 13:2–3
10	The Place of Prayer by the River	Lydia and the women of Philippi	Acts 16:13
11	Songs at Midnight	Paul and Silas	Acts 16:25
12	That You May Know Him Better	Paul's prayers (I)	Ephesians 1:17–18
13	Rooted and Grounded in Love	Paul's prayers (II)	Ephesians 3:17–19
14	When We Do Not Know What to Pray	The Spirit's help	Romans 8:26
15	Always Wrestling in Prayer	Epaphras	Colossians 4:12
16	Do Not Be Anxious About Anything	Paul in chains	Philippians 4:6–7
17	Pray Without Ceasing	Thessalonica	1 Thessalonians 5:16–18
18	For Kings and All in Authority	Timothy at Ephesus	1 Timothy 2:1–2
19	The Prayer of Faith	James, and Elijah's example	James 5:16
20	Golden Bowls	John on Patmos	Revelation 8:3–4

VOLUME 4

Faithful unto Death

Martyrs and Desert Fathers (AD 100–500) · 18 chapters

#	CHAPTER	PERSON / MOVEMENT	ANCHOR
1	Three Times a Day	The *Didache*	Psalm 55:17
2	A Prayer for Rulers Who Persecute	Clement of Rome ★	1 Timothy 2:1–2
3	Prayer on the Road to the Lions	Ignatius of Antioch ★	Philippians 1:21
4	"Eighty-Six Years I Have Served Him"	Polycarp	Revelation 2:10
5	Prayer in a Prison Cell	Perpetua and Felicity	Psalm 23:4
6	Prayer, the Wall of Faith	Tertullian	Ephesians 6:18
7	Prayer Rising Like Incense	Origen	Psalm 141:2
8	Why We Say "Our" Father	Cyprian of Carthage ★	Galatians 4:6
9	Into the Desert to Pray	Antony, by Athanasius ★	Hosea 2:14
10	A Struggle to the Last Breath	Desert Mothers and Fathers	Ephesians 6:12
11	"O God, Come to My Help"	John Cassian ★	Psalm 70:1
12	A Home Made a House of Prayer	Macrina the Younger	Psalm 31:5
13	Prayer in Song	Ephrem the Syrian	Colossians 3:16
14	Prayer, the Light of the Soul	John Chrysostom ★	Psalm 18:28
15	The Child of Those Tears	Monica ★	Lamentations 2:19
16	"Our Heart Is Restless"	Augustine ★	Psalm 62:1
17	Christ Be with Me	Patrick	Matthew 28:20
18	Lord Jesus Christ, Have Mercy	The Jesus Prayer	Luke 18:38

VOLUME 5

Seven Times a Day

Monks, Mystics and Missionaries (500–1500) · 17 chapters

#	CHAPTER	PERSON / MOVEMENT	ANCHOR
1	Ora et Labora: Pray and Work	Benedict	Psalm 119:164
2	Ethiopia Stretches Out Her Hands	The ancient Ethiopian Church	Psalm 68:31
3	Prayer on the Silk Road	Church of the East in China	Malachi 1:11
4	The Prayers of Ordinary Days	Columba and Celtic prayer	Psalm 121:8
5	Out of the Depths	Gregory of Narek (Armenia)	Psalm 130:1–4
6	Faith Seeking Your Face	Anselm ★	Psalm 27:8
7	Jesus, the Very Thought of You	Bernard of Clairvaux ★	1 John 4:19
8	Praise for Brother Sun	Francis of Assisi ⚑	Psalm 148:3
9	Gazing on Christ	Clare of Assisi	2 Corinthians 3:18
10	A Prayer Before Study	Thomas Aquinas	James 1:5
11	A Simple Reaching for God	*The Cloud of Unknowing*	Psalm 73:25
12	Waiting in Stillness	The Hesychasts of Mount Athos	Lamentations 3:26
13	"All Shall Be Well"	Julian of Norwich ★	Romans 8:28
14	Giving God No Rest	Catherine of Siena	Isaiah 62:6–7
15	Open My Eyes to Your Word	John Wycliffe and the Lollards	Psalm 119:18
16	Praying for Those Who Burn You	Jan Hus	Matthew 5:44
17	"Speak, Lord, Your Servant Is Listening"	Thomas à Kempis ★	1 Samuel 3:10

VOLUME 6

A Mighty Fortress

Prayer and the Reformation (1500–1650) · 17 chapters

#	CHAPTER	PERSON / MOVEMENT	ANCHOR
1	Too Busy Not to Pray	Martin Luther ★ ⚑	Psalm 46:1
2	A Simple Way to Pray	Luther's letter to his barber	Psalm 1:2
3	The Chief Exercise of Faith	John Calvin ★	Hebrews 4:16
4	Praying with the Mind Also	Thomas Cranmer and common prayer	1 Corinthians 14:15
5	"Give Me Scotland"	John Knox ⚑	Romans 10:1
6	Prayer as Friendship	Teresa of Ávila ★	John 15:15
7	The Dark Night	John of the Cross	Isaiah 50:10
8	Search Me, O God	Ignatius of Loyola and the examen	Psalm 139:23–24
9	Prayer for Busy People	Francis de Sales	Colossians 3:17
10	Prayer in a Secret Place	Japan's hidden Christians	Psalm 91:1
11	At Midnight I Rise	Lancelot Andrewes' private prayers	Psalm 119:62
12	Taste and See	George Herbert ★	Psalm 34:8
13	The Bruised Reed	Richard Sibbes ★	Isaiah 42:3
14	Set Your Mind on Things Above	Richard Baxter ★	Colossians 3:1–2
15	A Heart Without Words	John Bunyan ★	Psalm 62:8
16	Among the Pots and Pans	Brother Lawrence ★	1 Corinthians 10:31
17	Prayer in the Fire	The Anabaptist martyrs	Matthew 5:10

VOLUME 7

The Fire on the Altar

Pietists, Moravians and the Great Awakenings (1650–1800) · 17 chapters

#	CHAPTER	PERSON / MOVEMENT	ANCHOR
1	Be Still and Know	Jeanne Guyon ★	Psalm 46:10
2	Little Churches Within the Church	Philipp Spener's prayer circles	Malachi 3:16
3	An Orphanage Built on Prayer	August Hermann Francke	Psalm 68:5
4	The Fire Shall Never Go Out	Herrnhut, 1727	Leviticus 6:13
5	Worthy Is the Lamb	Zinzendorf and the Moravian missions	Revelation 5:9
6	The Apron Over Her Head	Susanna Wesley ★	Psalm 31:20
7	"God Does Nothing but in Answer to Prayer"	John Wesley ★	James 4:2
8	Oh, That You Would Tear the Heavens	George Whitefield ★	Isaiah 64:1
9	A Concert of Prayer	Jonathan Edwards ★	Zechariah 8:21
10	Praying in the Snow	David Brainerd ★	Galatians 4:19
11	Revive Your Work	Cambuslang, 1742	Habakkuk 3:2
12	"Résister"	Marie Durand and the Huguenot women	Galatians 6:9
13	Ask Large Petitions	John Newton ★ and the Olney prayer meeting	Ephesians 3:20
14	Pulled from Their Knees	Richard Allen ★ and Absalom Jones ★	Galatians 3:28
15	All the Families of the Nations	Samson Occom ★	Psalm 22:27
16	The Prayer Call of 1784	Northamptonshire Baptists	Isaiah 54:2
17	Expect Great Things	William Carey ★	Isaiah 54:3

VOLUME 8

Open Your Mouth Wide

The Great Century of Prayer (1800–1900) · 20 chapters

#	CHAPTER	PERSON / MOVEMENT	ANCHOR
1	A Prayer Meeting in the Rain	The Haystack Prayer Meeting, 1806	Matthew 28:19
2	The Man Who Prayed Ahead	Daniel Nash and Charles Finney ★ ⚑	Isaiah 66:8
3	A Covenant with God	Christmas Evans ★	Jeremiah 50:5
4	My Soul Thirsts for You	Robert Murray M'Cheyne ★ ⚑	Psalm 63:1
5	Open Your Mouth Wide	George Müller ★	Psalm 81:10
6	A Pilgrim Learns to Pray Without Ceasing	*The Way of a Pilgrim* (Russia)	1 Thessalonians 5:17
7	A Peaceful Spirit	Seraphim of Sarov	Isaiah 26:3
8	The Noon Prayer Meeting	Jeremiah Lanphier and Fulton Street, 1857	2 Chronicles 7:14
9	Four Young Men at Kells	The Ulster Revival, 1859	Psalm 85:6
10	The Boiler Room	Charles Spurgeon ★	Psalm 50:15
11	Move Men Through God	Hudson Taylor ★	Philippians 4:19
12	Overcomer	Pastor Hsi ★ (China)	1 John 4:4
13	The Bedridden Girl Who Prayed	D. L. Moody ★ and Marianne Adlard	Mark 9:23
14	Knee Drill	William ★ and Catherine Booth ★	Isaiah 61:1
15	Trust Without Fear	Amanda Berry Smith ★	Proverbs 3:5–6
16	A Bishop on His Knees	Samuel Ajayi Crowther ★	Psalm 72:8
17	Abide in Me	Andrew Murray ★	John 15:7
18	He Will Not Leave You	Mary Slessor ★	Deuteronomy 31:8
19	The Little Way	Thérèse of Lisieux	Matthew 18:3
20	God Looked for an Intercessor	E. M. Bounds ★	Isaiah 59:16

VOLUME 9

Revival Fires

Prayer and Awakening (1900–1950) · 20 chapters

#	CHAPTER	PERSON / MOVEMENT	ANCHOR
1	"Bend Me"	Evan Roberts and the Welsh Revival, 1904	Ephesians 5:18
2	Your Daughters Will Prophesy	Pandita Ramabai ★ and Mukti, 1905	Joel 2:28
3	A Stable on Azusa Street	William J. Seymour ★	Acts 1:8
4	Everyone Praying Aloud Together	Pyongyang, 1907	1 John 1:9
5	At the Break of Dawn	Kil Sun-ju and Korean dawn prayer	Psalm 46:5
6	Sowing in Tears	"Praying" John Hyde ★ ⚑	Psalm 126:5–6
7	Prayer Is Breathing	Sadhu Sundar Singh ★	Psalm 16:11
8	Let the Children Come	Amy Carmichael ★	Mark 10:14
9	Only Believe	Smith Wigglesworth ★	Mark 11:22
10	Standing in the Gap for a World at War	Rees Howells ★	Ezekiel 22:30
11	Here Am I, Send Me	Dora Yu ★	Isaiah 6:8
12	Prayer Bands Across Asia	John Sung	Acts 3:19
13	The Prayer Ministry of the Church	Watchman Nee ★	Matthew 18:18
14	My Times Are in Your Hand	Dietrich Bonhoeffer ★	Psalm 31:15
15	Give Thanks for the Fleas	Corrie ten Boom ★	1 Thessalonians 5:18
16	Over the Mountains with a Hundred Children	Gladys Aylward ★	Isaiah 41:10
17	Wake Up, Sleeper	The East African Revival: Simeon Nsibambi ★, Joe Church ★, Blasio Kigozi ★	Ephesians 5:14
18	Two Old Sisters on Lewis	Peggy and Christine Smith, the Hebrides, 1949	Isaiah 44:3
19	The Praying Farmers of Charlotte	Billy Graham ★	Isaiah 55:11
20	The Pursuit of God	A. W. Tozer ★	Psalm 42:1

VOLUME 10

Every Tribe and Tongue

The Global Praying Church (1950–today) · 20 chapters

#	CHAPTER	PERSON / MOVEMENT	ANCHOR
1	Ask of Me, and I Will Give You the Nations	Jim ★ and Elisabeth Elliot ★	Psalm 2:8
2	Before They Call, I Will Answer	Helen Roseveare ★ (Congo)	Isaiah 65:24
3	Prayer That Opens Closed Doors	Brother Andrew	Revelation 3:8
4	Living Together in Unity	Brother Roger and Taizé	Psalm 133:1
5	Prayer Gives a Clean Heart	Mother Teresa	Matthew 25:40
6	I Lift My Eyes to the Hills	Choi Ja-shil and Korea's prayer mountains	Psalm 121:1
7	Bless Those Who Persecute You	Festo Kivengere ★ and Janani Luwum ★	Romans 12:14
8	What Happens When Women Pray	Evelyn Christenson ★	Jeremiah 33:3
9	More Persecution, More Growth	Samuel Lamb and China's house churches	2 Corinthians 4:8–9
10	The Fast God Chooses	Derek Prince ★ and Bill Bright ★	Isaiah 58:6
11	My Sheep Hear My Voice	Loren Cunningham ★ and YWAM	John 10:27
12	Fresh Wind, Fresh Fire	Jim Cymbala and the Brooklyn Tabernacle	Isaiah 56:7
13	The 10/40 Window	Luis Bush and the AD2000 prayer movement	Revelation 7:9
14	Pray for the Peace of the City	Argentina and Almolonga	Jeremiah 29:7
15	The Fire Is Lit Again	Pete Greig and 24-7 Prayer, 1999	Leviticus 6:13
16	Your Kingdom Come	The Global Day of Prayer and Thy Kingdom Come	Matthew 6:10
17	All Night Before God	Africa's all-night prayer vigils	Luke 6:12
18	Prayer in a Shipping Container	Helen Berhane (Eritrea)	Hebrews 13:3
19	Not Bowing to the Image	Iran's house churches	Daniel 3:17–18
20	Awe and Intimacy	Tim Keller ★	Psalm 63:3

VOLUME 11

Golden Bowls

Your Place in the Prayer Meeting · 12 chapters + series appendices

#	CHAPTER	THEME	ANCHOR
1	One Prayer Meeting, Two Thousand Years Long	The cloud of witnesses	Hebrews 12:1
2	What the Witnesses Agree On	Threads through every era	Hebrews 11:6
3	Prayer and the Word	Praying Scripture	Psalm 119:18
4	Prayer and Fasting	Lessons across the centuries	Matthew 6:17–18
5	Alone and Together	The secret room and the prayer meeting	Acts 12:12
6	Waiting on the Lord	Persistence	Isaiah 40:31
7	When Heaven Seems Silent	Unanswered prayer	2 Corinthians 12:8–9
8	For All People	Intercession for the nations	1 Timothy 2:4
9	Restore Us, O God	Prayer and revival	Psalm 80:19
10	The Family Altar	Prayer in the home	Deuteronomy 6:6–7
11	A Rule of Prayer	Building your own rhythm	Psalm 92:1–2
12	"Come, Lord Jesus"	Praying until He comes	Revelation 22:20

Series appendices

- **A. Master Key Insights**: every insight in the series by theme
- **B. Master Scripture Index**: Genesis to Revelation, as *Vol. 8, ch. 5: George Müller*
- **C. Timeline**: every person and movement on one line
- **D. Prayer Methods Toolkit**: Luther's four strands, the examen, the Jesus Prayer, praying the Psalms, concert of prayer, ACTS, prayer walking, fasting, dawn prayer, *tongsung kido*
- **E. Keep Reading on Ochorus**: the library books by every person featured

Totals

11 volumes · 198 chapters · about 240,000 words. Each volume is about 20–25k words.

⚑ Stories to handle honestly

- **Francis of Assisi**: "Make me an instrument of Your peace" is not his. It first appears in 1912. Use the *Canticle of the Creatures* and the San Damiano prayer instead.

- **Luther**: "So much to do that I shall spend the first three hours in prayer" is attributed, not verified. Tell it as a saying, and lean on *A Simple Way to Pray* (1535).
- **Knox**: "Give me Scotland or I die" is tradition. Tell it as such.
- **M'Cheyne**: "What a man is on his knees before God..." is widely attributed. Check the *Memoir* (Bonar) before quoting it as his.
- **Daniel Nash**: most of what we know comes through Finney's circle. Keep it modest.
- **John Hyde**: the "souls a day" accounts come from devotional memoirs. Flag them as such.

Copyright care

- **Before 1929**: quote freely. Use the Ochorus library text verbatim where we hold the book.
- **Later voices** (Bonhoeffer in English, Tozer, Corrie ten Boom, Watchman Nee, Elisabeth Elliot, Keller, Cymbala, Greig and others): brief, attributed quotations only. Their stories are told in Ochorus's own words.

Writing order

1. **Volume 2** (Jesus): sets the voice and the chapter template.
2. **Volume 8** (the Great Century): the strongest stories, to showcase the series.
3. Then the rest. **Volume 11** comes last, because its appendices index all the others.